FOREIGN TRADE COMMITTEE.

A comprehensive, definite and economically sound foreign trade policy for the United States is of great importance. With a view to assisting to this end, the various governmental organizations at Washington which deal with foreign trade matters have felt it desirable to form, among themselves, a committee to be composed of one representative from each of the following Departments, Commissions, and Administrative Boards:

The Department of State.
The Department of the Treasury.
The Department of War.
The Department of the Interior.
The Department of the Navy.
The Department of Agriculture.
The Department of Labor.
The Department of Commerce.
The Post Office Department.
The Interstate Commerce Commission;
The Federal Trade Commission.
The Tariff Commission.
U. S. Shipping Board.
U. S. Railroad Administration.
The War Trade Board.

It shall be the duty of the committee hereby formed to consider and make suggestions concerning questions of foreign trade and commerce, with a view to promoting full coordination of effort.

(Signed) WOODROW WILSON.

The White House,
28 February, 1919.

(No. 3053-A)
(Rec 2599 # 5433)

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

FOR THE PRESS:

March 26, 1919.(#3)

The Department of State, through Acting Secretary of State William Phillips, today announced the organization of a co-ordinating Committee on Foreign Trade. An order authorizing such a committee was formally signed by the President on February 28th, during his recent visit to Washington.

The Committee includes representatives of all the governmental offices which deal in any way with foreign trade matters. Its duty is to formulate conclusions, and to harmonize and co-ordinate all governmental activities in any way connected with foreign trade, thus safeguarding the economic future of the nation.

The Committee will provide advisory and supervisory machinery of Government executives for unifying the work of further extending and developing the business interests of the United States in foreign channels.

Neither the Committee as a whole nor its subcommittees will deal with specific cases of foreign trade interests except as they may be brought to its attention by the different Government offices now handling these matters. In other words, the American business public will not have direct communication with the Committee, but will continue to deal as heretofore with the various pre-existing agencies of the Government.

At a preliminary meeting, which was held last Thursday in the office of Acting Secretary of State Polk, the following representatives of various governmental agencies were present:

Department of State,	Acting Secretary Polk, Mr. Lay, Mr. Frost.
Department of Commerce,	Acting Secretary Sweet, Mr. Cutler.
Shipping Board,	Chairman Hurley, Mr. Stevens.
Treasury Department,	Acting Secretary Rowe, Mr. McGuire.
Department of Agriculture,	Mr. Brand, Mr. Morman.
Department of Labor,	Acting Secretary Post.
Navy Department,	Admiral Peoples.
War Department,	Colonel Dunn.
War Trade Board,	Mr. DeLaittre,
Federal Trade Commission,	Commissioner Fort.
Tariff Commission,	Commissioner Culbertson.
Railroad Administration,	Mr. Spens.
Interstate Commerce Com.,	Acting Chairman Woolley.
Post Office Department,	Mr. Maddox.

A sub-committee on organization was created, with Julius G. Lay, Acting Foreign Trade Adviser of the Department of State, as Chairman. To this committee, composed of the representatives of the Department of State, Treasury Department, Department of Commerce, War Trade Board, Shipping Board, Railroad Administration, and the Tariff Commission, was assigned the task of organizing sub-committees for particular functions.

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(NOTE: Unofficial: Department not to be quoted. It is believed that this latest evidence of the Government's desire for a sound foreign trade policy will be welcomed by the American business community.

Among the urgent questions to be treated may be mentioned tonnage allocations and marine freights, cable and radio facilities, reconstruction loans and Latin American loans, consortiums for buying in Europe, labor and Immigration, "key industries" (like the dye industry), and strategic raw materials.

All the foregoing questions, and many others, are at present engaging the attention of different government officials in Washington; and it is to systematize the co-operation already taking place that the special Foreign Trade Committee has been formed. "Team work" on foreign trade policy from henceforth will be even closer than before.)

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